



MONTHLY UPDATE

Central African Republic: monthly update, August – September 2026

Edition of 2026-09-02 · 12 systems and instruments tracked

Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH · GOVERNANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · CAPACITY · DATA

Summary of the month

The statistical apparatus is the working part of the record. The statistics institute [completed the fourth census's third data-cleaning phase on 6 August](#), published the [aide-mÃ©moire rebasing the national accounts to 2019](#) and [opened the steering committee of the seventh multiple indicator cluster survey](#) â€” three exercises running at once in a base that holds few working systems.

Two services reached users. [Electricity bills became payable over mobile money at a Bangui launch on 4 August](#), under a contract dated October 2025, and [a telemedicine link is reported in use at a remote hospital](#), operated by an international medical organisation rather than the health ministry. The regulator [took its satellite-access rule into the field on 12 August](#), ordered by the digital economy ministry. On the policy side the public-finances digitalisation plan did not move: [a World Bank public finance review puts tax digitisation at the centre of its revenue roadmap](#), which is an external assessment rather than a step taken.

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

The World Bank published a public finance review of the Central African Republic on 2 July 2026, and it puts digitisation at the centre of what it proposes. Against domestic revenue of about [FCFA 187bn, or 10.1% of GDP, in a 2025 budget of about FCFA 385bn](#), it argues for a rise to 12% in the short and medium term and 15% in the long term, and estimates that [digitising the tax administration alone could raise up to two points of GDP in the short term](#). Electronic public procurement and a digital cadastre are named among its longer-term recommendations, against [63% of public contracts let by direct award in 2023 and 11% of domestically financed investment executed that year](#).

It is the first independent assessment the base holds of the ground the government's own public-finances digitalisation plan 2025-2027 covers. That plan's costed operational annex, due in April 2025, is still unpublished.

Data protection

The month's sharpest item is an allegation about surveillance. A critical outlet reported that [the president has turned to mobile operators to trace citizens through SIM card records](#). The account is one outlet's and the record held carries no official instrument authorising such tracing, no operator confirmation and no data-protection safeguard attached to it. It is recorded here because a claim of state access to subscriber records is the kind of thing a base should carry even before it is confirmed.

Standards

Enforcement of the satellite-access rule moved from communiqué to the street. On 12 August the regulator [began a control operation across Bangui — Damala, Benz-Vi and Miskine, and the Don Bosco and Marabéna roundabouts — to identify internet-access points absent from its own registers](#), on the digital economy minister's instruction. The ministry's estimate is [about 3,000 Starlink users in the country against 200 registered with the regulator](#), and the operation is to extend progressively to provincial cities.

Two of the operators visited said they had not been told registration was required and undertook to regularise. No register total is published, so the ratio stands on the ministry's own account.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

The country's dependence on one neighbour was examined. A published assessment [set out the options for reaching submarine cable capacity other than through Cameroon](#). For a landlocked country, the transit route is the bandwidth constraint. The assessment names alternatives; the record held carries no route secured, no agreement signed and no capacity figure.

Data Storage

The base's only entry on storage this month is a continental project prospectus. A regional data-centre programme [is listed at the definition stage, 25% complete](#), with no site, capacity, cost or operator attached to it, and the base holds no account of where the country's own public systems are hosted.

DPI

Digital Payments and Fintech

Electricity bills became payable over mobile money at [a Bangui launch on 4 August, under a contract dated October 2025](#), a partnership between a mobile operator and the state electricity utility. No tariff, coverage figure or transaction volume is published, and the ten months between contract and launch is the only measure the base holds of what such a build takes in time here.

Sectoral management information systems

Health information in the window is a single link run by someone other than the state. A remote hospital [is using telemedicine to reach a global network of healthcare professionals](#), the service run by an international medical organisation rather than the health ministry. One site is a capability and not yet a system: no case volume, connectivity arrangement or continuity plan is published, so what happens to the link when the organisation leaves is not on record.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

An operator described its own contribution. Orange [published an account of work to build more accessible and inclusive public digital services in the country](#). It names no service and carries no user figure, and it is the operator's own account of its role rather than the state's account of what it has delivered.

Capacity

Research institutions

Nothing moved in the research base this period. What changed is the record: the base had carried no university, statistics-institute or donor research document for the country at all, and now holds the University of Bangui's [Institut supérieur de technologie](#), which supplies most of the country's professional engineering graduates and runs a master's in engineering sciences. The page carries no date, enrolment or research-output figure, so the position it settles is one of existence rather than of scale.

Data

National statistics

The statistics institute [deployed enumerator teams nationwide on 20 July, opening six months of collection across about 7,000 households in three two-month waves, entirely by tablet](#), with a public commitment to statistical secrecy and aggregates only. The field period ends around January 2027; no results date is stated and no prior harmonised survey is held.

Two further statistical operations surfaced in August, both financed by the World Bank. The [third data-cleaning phase of the fourth population and housing census was presented on 6 August](#), a step toward definitive results from the country's first digital census; cleaning has been running since May 2026, under the HISWACA-SOP2 project with UNFPA as technical partner. No enumeration total or publication date is stated.

The institute also [released the aide-mémoire on rebasing the national accounts to 2019 under SCN 2008](#), moving off a 2005 base built on SCN 1993 and drawing on the 2021 agriculture and household living-conditions surveys to widen coverage of agriculture, household consumption, self-build, imputed rent and informal activity. The peer review it records was held in February 2023; what is new is its publication, and the record states no rebased GDP level.

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